FRANCE, 1719

A share went from ~500 to 10,000 livres.

> Two years later: back to 500.

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John Law: Scottish gambler, economist, hired to fix France's money.

His bank became the Banque Royale, backed by the king.

The Mississippi Company: riches from Louisiana, plus France's trade monopolies.

Louisiana

Trade monopolies

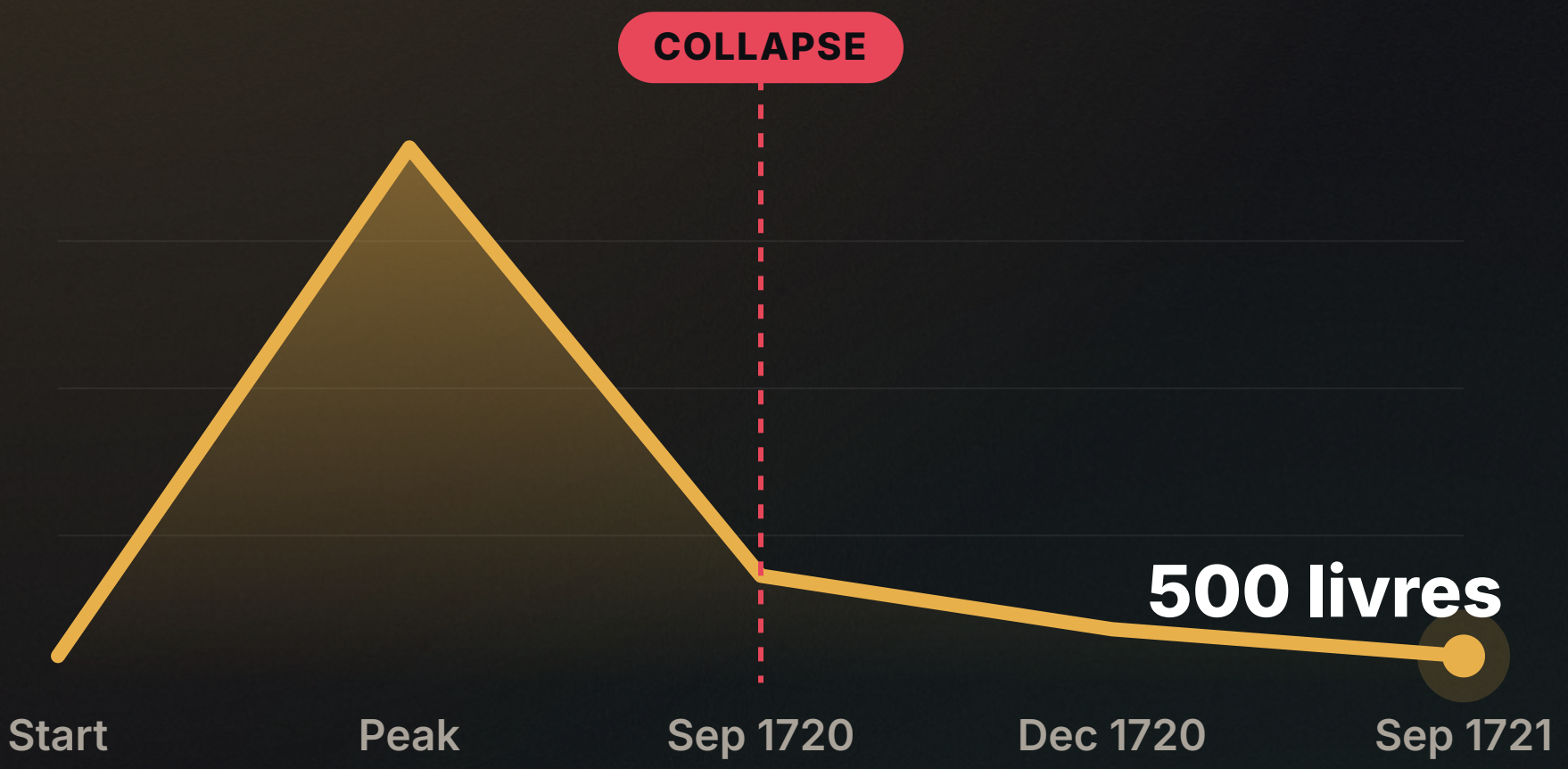
Royal bank

Share price, in livres:

Only documented points are shown; peak reached during the 1719 speculation.

Law becomes Controller General of Finances.

Share price, in livres:



Documented points only.

Law dismissed. Flees to Brussels, then Venice.

By 1721, shares were back at 500.

> Right where they started.

YOUR RULE

When a price rises on a story:

1. Can anyone check the story?
2. What's it worth if it's wrong?
3. Would you buy it without the hype?

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